

Rule Book Module M3  
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# Managing incidents, floods and snow

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## Conventions used in the Rule Book

### Example

A black line in the margin indicates a change to that rule since the last printed version. The Rule Book Briefing Leaflet in the online Standards Catalogue contains more information about the changes.

Green text in the margin indicates who is responsible for carrying out the rule.

driver

A white i in a blue box indicates that there is information provided at the bottom of the page.



A rule printed inside a red box is considered to be critical and is therefore emphasised in this way.

If you do not understand anything in the Rule Book, ask your manager or supervisor to explain it to you.

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You will need this module if you carry out the duties of:

- driver
- signaller.

You will also need this module if you are likely to be involved in, or reporting, a serious accident.

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## Managing incidents, floods and snow

## 1

## Preserving evidence after a serious accident

*The people responsible: anyone involved, signaller*

### 1.1 Carrying out emergency action

anyone  
involved

As a priority over preserving and recording evidence, if it is your responsibility you must:

- secure the train
- protect the line
- get the electric traction current switched off
- call the emergency services
- make sure the public and other personnel are safe.

### 1.2 Leaving evidence undisturbed

anyone  
involved

You must not disturb or interfere with evidence of the cause of a serious accident, unless told by:

- a rail incident officer (RIO)
- a police incident officer
- a rail accident investigation branch (RAIB) investigator
- any other senior investigator.

You must immediately make a note of evidence that might be lost over time, such as wheel-tyre and brake-block temperatures, and brake-gauge readings.

## 1.3 Entering a driving cab

### a) Reasons

You must only enter a driving cab if you have to:

- secure the train
- carry out rescue operations
- use the cab radio to call the emergency services or speak to the signaller
- get equipment to carry out protection of the line or extinguish a fire
- make a note of short-life evidence.

anyone  
involved

If you enter a driving cab for any of these reasons, you must be careful not to disturb unnecessarily equipment, handles, buttons or switches, including ERTMS controls, displays and indications.

### b) Noting information

After you have carried out any of the actions shown above, you must:

- make a detailed note of the original position or location of equipment and gauges
- before you leave the scene, give this information to an investigating officer, such as the RIO, police incident officer, RAIB investigator or other senior investigator.

## 1.4 Locking cab doors

You must arrange to prevent unauthorised entry to the cab from which the train was being driven and if possible:

- lock the doors to that cab
- make sure other driving cab doors are locked.

anyone  
involved

## Managing incidents, floods and snow

### 1.5 Signalling equipment

#### a) Equipment not to be moved

anyone  
involved

You must not move signalling equipment directly associated with the accident, even for testing purposes, until you are authorised to do so.

This does not apply to equipment that must be used to protect the accident.

#### b) Noting information

signaller

You must:

- make a detailed note of the position the relevant signalling equipment was in at the time of the accident
- record any subsequent changes to the position of the signalling equipment concerned.



# 2

## **Derailments, collisions or heavy impacts**

*The people responsible: driver, signaller*

### **2.1 Derailments**

If any vehicle has been derailed, you must not allow it, or any part of the train, to enter or continue in service until it has been examined by a rolling stock technician.

**driver,  
signaller**

However, if the derailment was at slow speed, vehicles that were not derailed or coupled next to a derailed vehicle can be examined at the first suitable location.

### **2.2 Collisions or heavy impacts with other vehicles or buffer stops**

If any vehicle has suffered a collision or heavy impact, you must not allow it, or any part of the train, to enter or continue in service until it has been examined by a rolling stock technician.

**driver,  
signaller**

### **2.3 Trains colliding with obstructions on the line**

#### **a) Checking the train**

Following a collision with an obstruction on the line, you must bring your train to a stand and check for any damage that:

**driver**

- might have been caused by the collision
- might affect its safe movement.

## Managing incidents, floods and snow

### driver

You must speak to your train operating company's control if it is possible that any of the following have been damaged.

- Brake equipment.
- Coupling and drawgear.
- Vehicle suspension.
- Wheelsets.
- Current collection equipment.
- Lifeguards.

You must also speak to your train operating company's control if you think that damage may have increased the width or height of the train.

You will then be told one of the following.

- The train operating company's control considers that the train is fit to proceed.
- The train operating company's control does not consider the train fit to proceed until a rolling stock technician has examined the damaged vehicle and decided that it is fit for further movement.

In either case you will be told about any restrictions that would apply, for example a maximum speed when proceeding.

When you have been told that the train is fit to continue its journey, you must not consider this as permission for the train to proceed. You must tell the signaller what you have been told by the train operating company's control.

### signaller

You must tell Operations Control what the driver has told you, and not allow the train to proceed on its journey until Operations Control tell you that you can. You must tell the driver about any instructions you have been given by Operations Control.

### driver

You must not proceed on your journey until the signaller gives you permission. You must carry out any instructions the signaller gives you.

## **b) Detaching and moving a vehicle**

If any part of a vehicle has become loose and cannot be secured, or might make contact with the track or lineside structures, you must arrange for the vehicle to be cleared from the running line at the first suitable location.

driver

Before moving the vehicle, you must:

- get the signaller's permission
- get authority from a rolling stock technician if you are not sure the movement can be made safely
- if possible, move passengers from the vehicle.

During the movement you must not exceed 10 mph (15 km/h) or 5 mph (10 km/h) over points and crossings.

Before you give permission for the vehicle to be moved, you must make sure trains are stopped on any adjacent lines that might be affected.

signaller

# 3

## Bodies on the line

*The person responsible: **signaller***

### 3.1 Signaller's actions

**signaller**

If you are told about a body that is on or near the line, you must:

- find out the location of the body in relation to running lines
- if necessary, arrange for an emergency switch-off of the electric traction current
- tell Operations Control about the circumstances.

### 3.2 Dealing with trains

**signaller**

You must arrange for trains to be stopped on all lines until you have found out where the body is.

You may allow trains to proceed if:

- you have been told that the body is clear of the line
- the body cannot be struck by a passing train
- the body parts are not recognisable.

You may allow a train to pass recognisable body parts if they are in a position where they cannot be seen by passengers on passing trains (for example when the remains are very close to the line but not foul of it).

You must tell each driver about the circumstances and get the driver's agreement to the movement.

# 4 Flood, flowing or pooling water

*The people responsible: driver, signaller*

## 4.1 Reporting procedure

You must report to the signaller, stopping your train specially to do so if necessary, if you see any flood water that might affect the passage of trains. You must tell the signaller if you believe the flood water:

- is up to the bottom of the rail head
- is up to the top of the rail head
- is above the top of the rail head
- is moving and likely to dislodge the ballast
- has dislodged the ballast.

You must arrange for Operations Control to be told if vehicles are stabled in or pass through flood water that is above the bottom of the axle box.

driver

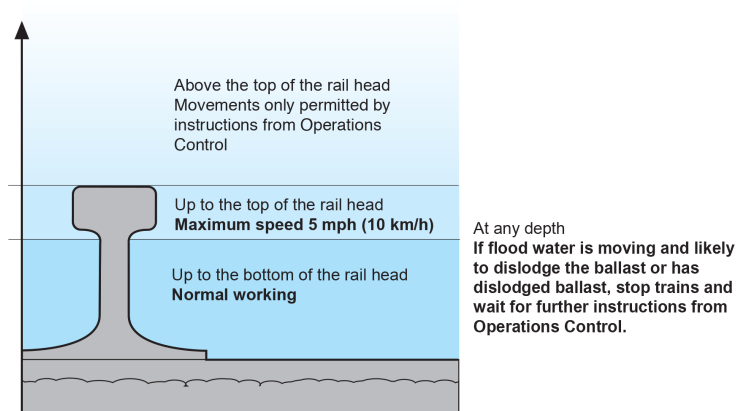


Diagram M3.1

## Managing incidents, floods and snow

### 4.2 Train running

#### signaller

When you receive a report of flood water, you must tell Operations Control immediately.

You must find out if the flood water:

- is up to the bottom of the rail head
- is up to the top of the rail head
- is above the top of the rail head
- is moving and likely to dislodge the ballast
- has dislodged the ballast.

As long as the flood water is not moving in a way that is likely to dislodge any ballast, and has not dislodged any ballast, you may allow trains to:

- continue normally if the water is up to the bottom of the rail head
- run at a maximum speed of 5 mph (10 km/h) if the water is no deeper than the top of the rail head.

If the water is deeper than the top of the rail head, you must:

- suspend the normal running of trains
- tell Operations Control and wait for further instructions.

### 4.3 Reporting procedure for flowing or pooling water

#### driver

You must immediately tell the signaller, stopping your train specially to do so if necessary, if you see any of the following that might affect structures or earthworks.

- Water rising up from the track or the cess.
- Unusual amounts of water pooling next to the track or in the cess.
- Water flowing down or pouring out of the sides of embankments or cuttings.

You must tell the signaller the exact location and details, including whether the water is displacing any material.

driver

#### **4.4 Train running when flowing or pooling water that might affect structures or earthworks is reported**

When you receive a report of flowing or pooling water that might affect structures or earthworks, you must reach a clear understanding with the person making the report about:

signaller

- the location of the water
- whether the water is flowing or pooling
- whether the water is displacing any material
- what is being affected by the water, (for example, the track, the cess, an embankment, a cutting or another structure).

If the report is of flood water on the track, you must carry out the instructions shown in section 4.2 of this module.

If the report is of water affecting the cess, an embankment, a cutting or another structure, you must tell Operations Control what has happened and carry out any instructions you are given.

You must arrange for the first train to pass over each line to examine the line at the location of the flowing or pooling water, unless Operations Control tells you to do something different.

If, after examining a line, the driver tells you that it does not appear to be safe for the passage of trains, you must arrange for a competent engineer to examine the line at the location where the flowing or pooling water was reported.

You must take any other actions shown in the *Signal Box Special Instructions*.

If, after examining a line, the driver reports that the line appears to be unaffected, you may allow trains to continue to run on that line at caution.

## Managing incidents, floods and snow

### signaller

You must not allow trains to run normally on any line at the location where the flowing or pooling water was reported unless one of the following applies.

- Operations Control has given you permission to do so.
- The *Signal Box Special Instructions* allow you to do so.
- A competent engineer has told you it is safe to do so.



# 5

## Snow

*The people responsible: driver, signaller*

### 5.1 Reporting procedure

You must report to the signaller, stopping your train specially to do so if necessary, if you see any build-up of snow that might affect the passage of trains. You must tell the signaller if you believe the snow is deeper than 200 mm (8 inches) above the top of the rail head.

driver

### 5.2 Train running

Normal running can take place unless you are told that snow is deeper than 200 mm (8 inches) above the top of the rail head.

signaller

If you are told that snow is deeper than 200 mm (8 inches) above the top of the rail head, you must:

- suspend the normal running of trains
- tell Operations Control and wait for further instructions.

# 6

## Independent snow ploughs

*The person responsible: signaller*

### 6.1 Working on adjacent lines

**signaller**

You must make sure that adjacent lines are clear of trains when ploughing is in progress.

You do not need to carry out this instruction when ploughs are set to push snow to the cess side only, as long as the person in charge of the ploughing has made sure that:

- there is no danger to trains on the other line, and
- you have been told about this arrangement.

### 6.2 Operating on electrified lines

**signaller**

Before ploughing starts on an electrified line, you must:

- tell the electrical control operator
- arrange for the electricity to be switched off on a line which has a conductor rail
- arrange for the electricity to be switched off on a line which has overhead line equipment, if the depth of snow is more than 900 mm (3 feet).

# 7

## Damage to structures or earthworks above or below the line

*The people responsible: driver, signaller*

### 7.1 Reporting procedure

You must immediately tell the signaller, stopping your train specially to do so if necessary, if you see any damage to structures or earthworks above or below the line.

driver

This includes events such as:

- landslips
- washouts
- embankment failures
- retaining wall failures.

You must give the exact location and details of the damage, including which lines are affected.

### 7.2 Train running when damage to structures or earthworks is reported

When you receive a report of damage to structures or earthworks you must reach a clear understanding with the person making the report about:

signaller

- the location and details of the damage
- which lines are affected.

For any line that is affected by damage to structures or earthworks, you must immediately carry out the instructions in regulation 4 of the appropriate *Train signalling regulations*.

You must tell Operations Control what has happened and carry out any instructions you are given.

## Managing incidents, floods and snow

### signaller

You must arrange for a competent engineer to examine the line at the location of the reported damage to structures or earthworks.

You must take any other action shown in the *Signal Box Special Instructions*.

#### **Lines that are reported to be affected by damage to structures or earthworks**

You must not use a train to examine any lines that are reported to be affected.

You must not allow trains to run on any line that is reported to be affected until a competent engineer has made sure that the line is safe for trains to pass.

#### **Lines at the same location that are not reported to be affected by damage to structures or earthworks**

On each line that is not reported as affected, you must arrange for the first train to pass over that line to examine the line at the location of the reported damage, unless Operations Control tells you to do something different.

If, after examining the line, the driver reports that the line appears to be unaffected, you may allow trains to continue to run on that line at caution.

You must not allow trains to run normally on any line that appears to be unaffected unless one of the following applies.

- Operations Control has given you permission to do so.
- The *Signal Box Special Instructions* allow you to do so.
- A competent engineer has told you it is safe to do so.

## 7.3 Report of extreme weather from Operations Control

If you have not received any reports of possible damage to structures or earthworks, but are told by Operations Control about extreme weather within your area of control, you must carry out the instructions you are given. These instructions may include arranging for:

- affected lines to be examined
- cautioning trains through the affected area
- a blanket speed restriction within the affected area.

If you are told to impose a blanket speed restriction you can use a GSM-R broadcast message to inform drivers. Drivers do not have to acknowledge the message.

You must not allow trains to return to running normally until Operations Control gives you permission to do so.

If signallers have been told by Operations Control about extreme weather, they may have been instructed to impose a blanket speed restriction within the affected area. The signaller can do this by a GSM-R broadcast message, which you do not have to acknowledge.

signaller

driver







**Contact:** <https://customer-portal.rssb.co.uk/>  
**Tel:** +44 [0] 20 3142 5300  
**Web:** [www.rssb.co.uk](http://www.rssb.co.uk)

